

Every entry answers these

1. What **skill** was practiced?
2. What did the **client** do?
3. What **support or teaching** did staff provide?
4. How did the client **respond**?
5. What needs to happen **next**? (*when there is follow-up*)

Prioritize 1–4. Mark Yes only for goals you actually worked on.

Name the support — action phrases

Staff supported client... Staff demonstrated... Staff guided client...

Staff prompted client to... Staff reviewed with client...

- Verbal prompting
- Demonstration
- Education
- Researching options
- Role-playing
- Community-based instruction
- Assistance making appointments
- Follow-up from last session
- Modeling
- Reminders
- Problem solving
- Reviewing information
- Advocacy
- Public transit instruction
- Communicating with providers

Write about the client, not yourself

✗ WEAK

“Staff took John grocery shopping.”

✓ STRONG

“John developed a grocery list with staff support and accompanied staff to the grocery store. John located most items independently and requested assistance comparing prices on several items.”

Be objective

✗ JUDGMENT

“Client was lazy and didn’t want to work on his budget.” • “Client was rude.”

✓ OBSERVATION

“Client declined to work on budgeting during today’s session and stated he wanted to address the goal at the next visit.”

Document these changes, then tell your supervisor

- Change in housing
- Medical concerns
- Employment changes
- Behavioral / emotional concerns
- Trouble accessing basic needs
- Hospitalization
- Changes in benefits
- Safety concerns
- Change in contact info
- Change in ability to work a goal

Transportation language

MLS is not a transportation provider. Never suggest transportation was the service.

✗ NEVER WRITE

✓ WRITE INSTEAD

“Staff drove client...”

“Staff accompanied client to...”

“Staff picked up client...”

“Staff met client at...”

“Staff dropped off client...”

“Staff assisted client with accessing transportation...”

“Staff transported client...” /
“provided a ride...”

Rewrite around the skill you taught.

Teaching transportation is a legitimate ILS skill. Planning a bus route, reading a schedule, using a transit card, waiting safely at a stop — document those as instruction. Providing the ride itself is not a service.

Non-negotiables

- **Notes before clock-out.** You cannot clock out until that shift’s notes are complete — written at the end of the session, not from memory later.
- **In person is the standard.** Anything else needs **prior** supervisor approval. It cannot be obtained after the fact.
- **Never** document a call, attempted contact, or no-show as an in-person session.
- **No response or no-show?** Contact a supervisor and document what actually occurred.
- **Found an error in a submitted note?** Contact your supervisor. Do not alter it yourself.

Never do these

- ✗ Document a service, activity, or contact that did not occur
- ✗ Copy and paste a previous note and submit it as new
- ✗ State that a client was present when they were not
- ✗ Adjust service times to match a schedule when the actual times were different
- ✗ Document progress you did not observe
- ✗ Sign another employee’s documentation
- ✗ Use ChatGPT or other AI to write your notes

Before you submit

- ☐ Completing this note before clocking out?
- ☐ Date and times accurate?
- ☐ Not in person — changes made and approval obtained?
- ☐ Marked Yes only for goals actually worked on?
- ☐ Each entry explains the skill practiced?
- ☐ Explained what the client did?
- ☐ Explained what staff did, specifically?
- ☐ Documented the client’s response or progress?
- ☐ Noted needed follow-up?
- ☐ Language objective and professional?
- ☐ Avoided any transportation wording?
- ☐ Could another staff member know what happens next?